

## **MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

### **Recommendation for UI/UX Designers and Developers**

#### **1. Executive Summary**

MyLeaseAudit already has a Notes concept, but the needed functionality is broader than simple note-taking. The recommended solution is to enhance Notes into **contextual Notes & Discussions**.

This should not be a Slack-style chat system and should not be a separate chat module. Instead, discussions should be attached directly to the audit item being discussed.

Recommended name:

Notes & Discussions

Purpose:

Allow users to ask questions, comment, tag specific users, receive notifications, attach support, record decisions, and resolve discussions directly within the audit context.

#### **2. Product Principle**

The discussion should stay attached to the work item.

Users should be able to discuss:

Audit

Document

Validation Finding

Finding / Observation

Checklist Item

Approval Request

Savings Record

Generated Report

without leaving the current screen.

#### **3. Problem Being Solved**

Current-style notes are usually passive.

They answer:

What did someone write down?

## **MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

The enhanced Notes & Discussions feature should answer:

Who asked the question?

Who was asked?

Who responded?

What was decided?

Was the issue resolved?

Where is the discussion attached?

Was the notified user alerted?

### **4. Recommended UX Approach**

#### **4.1 Do Not Build Full Slack**

Do not build:

Channels

Open chat rooms

Team-wide feeds

General chat

Real-time social chat

That would create unnecessary complexity.

#### **4.2 Build Contextual Discussion Threads**

Build:

Object-level discussion threads

Threaded replies

@mentions

Email notifications

In-app notifications

Attachments

Open / Resolved status

Activity logging

Search

## MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement

### 5. Supported Parent Objects

Each of these should support Notes & Discussions:

| Parent Object             | Discussion Support |
|---------------------------|--------------------|
| Audit header / audit file | Yes                |
| Document                  | Yes                |
| Validation Finding        | Yes                |
| Finding / Observation     | Yes                |
| Checklist Item            | Yes                |
| Approval Request          | Yes                |
| Savings Record            | Yes                |
| Generated Report / Output | Yes                |

Each thread must store:

parent\_object\_type

parent\_object\_id

audit\_id

audit\_year\_id, where applicable

### 6. UI Placement

Every supported record should show a discussion indicator.

Example:

OBS-17 Management Fee Overcharge

[Discussion 8]

or:

 8

Where the number equals total messages in the thread.

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If there are unresolved questions, show a visible status indicator:

Discussion 8 — Open

**7. Main UI Pattern**

Use a **right-side discussion drawer**.

Reason:

Keeps the user in context

Avoids navigation away from the audit record

Works across Validation, Observations, Checklist, Approvals, Savings, and Documents

**8. UI Image**

The wireframe image shows the recommended pattern:

- Main audit workspace on the left.
- Selected finding with Discussion button.
- Right-side Notes & Discussions drawer.
- Typed message composer.
- @mention use.
- Message types.
- Mark Resolved control.

[Open UI wireframe image](#)

**9. Wireframe: Object-Level Discussion Entry**

|                             |  |
|-----------------------------|--|
|                             |  |
| OBS-17                      |  |
| Management Fee Overcharge   |  |
|                             |  |
| Status: Confirmed           |  |
| Potential Savings: \$24,000 |  |
|                             |  |

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[Edit] [Create Savings] [Discussion 8 Open]

### 10. Wireframe: Discussion Drawer

|                                                   |  |
|---------------------------------------------------|--|
| NOTES & DISCUSSIONS                               |  |
| OBS-17: Management Fee Overcharge                 |  |
| Status: Open   Participants: 3   Attachments: 2   |  |
| QUESTION                                          |  |
| Sarah M.   May 20, 2026 9:14 AM                   |  |
| Need confirmation of lease clause 4.3.            |  |
| @John Davis can you review?                       |  |
| COMMENT                                           |  |
| John D.   May 20, 2026 11:02 AM                   |  |
| Clause 4.3 limits management fee to 3%.           |  |
| I attached the lease excerpt.                     |  |
| DECISION                                          |  |
| Sarah M.   May 20, 2026 11:20 AM                  |  |
| Confirmed. Updating finding and savings estimate. |  |
| [Mark Resolved] [Reopen] [Attach File]            |  |
| Type message... use @ to mention a user           |  |
| [Send]                                            |  |

## **MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

### **11. Message Types**

Each message should have a type.

| <b>Message Type</b> | <b>Purpose</b>                |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|
| Comment             | General note or update        |
| Question            | A question needing response   |
| Decision            | A documented conclusion       |
| Review Request      | Request for QC/PM/user review |
| Approval Note       | Comment related to approval   |
| System Message      | Auto-generated event          |

Default type:

Comment

User may select another type from a dropdown.

### **12. Thread Status**

Each discussion thread should have a status.

| <b>Status</b> | <b>Meaning</b>                           |
|---------------|------------------------------------------|
| Open          | Active discussion                        |
| Answered      | A question has received a response       |
| Resolved      | Issue/question resolved                  |
| Closed        | Finalized and locked or no longer active |

Recommended lifecycle:

Open

↓

Answered

↓

Resolved

↓

## **MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

Closed

### **13. Message-Level Status**

For message types such as Question or Review Request, support message-level status.

#### **Message Status Meaning**

|          |                   |
|----------|-------------------|
| Open     | Needs response    |
| Answered | Response provided |
| Resolved | Accepted/resolved |
| Closed   | No further action |

This allows one thread to contain multiple questions.

### **14. @Mentions**

Support user mentions using:

@First Last

UX behavior:

User types @

System opens searchable user dropdown

User selects person

Mention becomes tagged

Mentioned user receives notification

Mention search should include:

Auditors

Project Managers

Admins

QC reviewers

Users assigned to the audit

Users in assigned user groups

## **MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

### **15. Notifications**

#### **15.1 In-App Notifications**

Create in-app notifications for:

User mentioned

Question assigned

Review requested

Reply to user's question

Discussion resolved

Discussion reopened

Example:

You were mentioned in OBS-17: Management Fee Overcharge.

#### **15.2 Email Notifications**

Send email notification when a user is mentioned or assigned a question/review request.

Example subject:

You were mentioned in MyLeaseAudit

Example body:

Sarah M. mentioned you in:

OBS-17 — Management Fee Overcharge

Message:

Can you confirm whether lease clause 4.3 limits the management fee to 3%?

[View Discussion]

#### **15.3 Notification Controls**

Users should be able to receive notifications for:

Mentions only

Mentions and replies

All discussions on assigned audits



## **MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

At minimum, implement mentions and assigned question/review notifications.

### **16. Attachments**

Allow attachments to discussion messages.

Attachment types:

PDF

DOCX

XLSX

Image

Screenshot

Calculation file

Document link

Attachments should either:

1. Link to an existing MyLeaseAudit document, or
2. Upload a new file and associate it with the discussion message.

### **17. Activity Logging**

Every discussion event should create an activity entry.

Examples:

Discussion message added

Question asked

User mentioned

Attachment added

Question answered

Discussion resolved

Discussion reopened

Discussion closed

This preserves the audit trail.

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## MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement

### 18. Search and Filters

Users should be able to search Notes & Discussions across an audit.

Filters:

Keyword

User

Mentioned user

Parent object type

Parent object ID

Audit year

Status

Message type

Date range

Has attachment

Unresolved only

Suggested search location:

Audit-level Notes & Discussions search panel

Do not create a full chat tab unless later needed. Search can be part of existing Notes area or global audit search.

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### 19. Dashboard Additions

Add a dashboard widget for collaboration.

|                     |    |  |
|---------------------|----|--|
| Notes & Discussions |    |  |
| My Mentions         | 3  |  |
| Open Questions      | 12 |  |
| Pending Reviews     | 5  |  |
| Resolved This Week  | 18 |  |

**MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

Minimum dashboard metrics:

My Mentions

Open Questions

Pending Review Requests

Unresolved Discussions

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**20. Recommended Fields**

**20.1 DiscussionThread**

| Field              | Type                         | Required    | Notes                                                                                                           |
|--------------------|------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| thread_id          | System ID                    | Yes         | Auto-generated                                                                                                  |
| audit_id           | Foreign key                  | Yes         | Parent audit                                                                                                    |
| audit_year_id      | Foreign key                  | Conditional | Required if parent object is year-specific                                                                      |
| parent_object_type | Dropdown/String enum         | Yes         | Audit, Document, ValidationFinding, Observation, ChecklistItem, ApprovalRequest, SavingsRecord, GeneratedOutput |
| parent_object_id   | Foreign key / polymorphic ID | Yes         | ID of the object being discussed                                                                                |
| thread_title       | Short text                   | Yes         | Usually inherited from parent object                                                                            |
| status             | Dropdown                     | Yes         | Open, Answered, Resolved, Closed                                                                                |
| priority           | Dropdown                     | Optional    | Low, Normal, High, Urgent                                                                                       |
| message_count      | Number                       | Yes         | Derived                                                                                                         |
| unresolved_count   | Number                       | Yes         | Derived                                                                                                         |
| participant_count  | Number                       | Yes         | Derived                                                                                                         |
| attachment_count   | Number                       | Yes         | Derived                                                                                                         |
| created_by         | User                         | Yes         | Auto                                                                                                            |
| created_at         | DateTime                     | Yes         | Auto                                                                                                            |
| updated_at         | DateTime                     | Yes         | Auto                                                                                                            |

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| Field       | Type     | Required | Notes |
|-------------|----------|----------|-------|
| resolved_by | User     | Optional |       |
| resolved_at | DateTime | Optional |       |
| closed_by   | User     | Optional |       |
| closed_at   | DateTime | Optional |       |

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### 20.2 DiscussionMessage

| Field               | Type                  | Required    | Notes                                                                      |
|---------------------|-----------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| message_id          | System ID             | Yes         | Auto-generated                                                             |
| thread_id           | Foreign key           | Yes         | Parent thread                                                              |
| parent_message_id   | Foreign key           | Optional    | For threaded replies                                                       |
| message_type        | Dropdown              | Yes         | Comment, Question, Decision, Review Request, Approval Note, System Message |
| message_text        | Long text / rich text | Yes         | Supports mentions                                                          |
| message_status      | Dropdown              | Conditional | Open, Answered, Resolved, Closed                                           |
| assigned_to         | User / multi-user     | Optional    | For questions/review requests                                              |
| created_by          | User                  | Yes         | Auto                                                                       |
| created_at          | DateTime              | Yes         | Auto                                                                       |
| edited_at           | DateTime              | Optional    |                                                                            |
| deleted_at          | DateTime              | Optional    | Soft delete only                                                           |
| is_internal         | Boolean               | Yes         | Default true                                                               |
| is_system_generated | Boolean               | Yes         | Default false                                                              |

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### 20.3 DiscussionMention

## MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement

| Field               | Type        | Required Notes |                             |
|---------------------|-------------|----------------|-----------------------------|
| mention_id          | System ID   | Yes            | Auto-generated              |
| message_id          | Foreign key | Yes            | Parent message              |
| mentioned_user_id   | User        | Yes            | Mentioned person            |
| notification_status | Dropdown    | Yes            | Pending, Sent, Failed, Read |
| email_sent          | Boolean     | Yes            |                             |
| in_app_sent         | Boolean     | Yes            |                             |
| created_at          | DateTime    | Yes            | Auto                        |
| read_at             | DateTime    | Optional       |                             |

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### 20.4 DiscussionAttachment

| Field         | Type             | Required Notes |                                |
|---------------|------------------|----------------|--------------------------------|
| attachment_id | System ID        | Yes            | Auto-generated                 |
| message_id    | Foreign key      | Yes            | Parent message                 |
| document_id   | Foreign key      | Optional       | Existing MyLeaseAudit document |
| file_url      | URL              | Optional       | If externally stored           |
| file_name     | Text             | Yes            |                                |
| file_type     | Text / MIME type | Yes            |                                |
| uploaded_by   | User             | Yes            |                                |
| uploaded_at   | DateTime         | Yes            |                                |

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## 21. Permissions

| Function                           | Auditor | QC  | Reviewer | Project Manager | Admin |
|------------------------------------|---------|-----|----------|-----------------|-------|
| View discussions on assigned audit | Yes     | Yes | Yes      | Yes             | Yes   |
| Create message                     | Yes     | Yes | Yes      | Yes             | Yes   |

## MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement

| Function                        | Auditor | QC Reviewer | Project Manager | Admin |
|---------------------------------|---------|-------------|-----------------|-------|
| Reply to message                | Yes     | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   |
| Mention user                    | Yes     | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   |
| Attach file                     | Yes     | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   |
| Mark own question resolved      | Yes     | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   |
| Mark any discussion resolved    | No      | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   |
| Reopen discussion               | No      | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   |
| Close discussion                | No      | No          | Yes             | Yes   |
| Delete inappropriate message    | No      | No          | No              | Yes   |
| Configure notification settings | No      | No          | Limited         | Yes   |

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## 22. API Requirements

Minimum endpoints:

GET /discussion/thread?parent\_object\_type=&parent\_object\_id=

POST /discussion/thread

POST /discussion/message

POST /discussion/message/{id}/reply

PATCH /discussion/message/{id}

POST /discussion/message/{id}/mention

POST /discussion/message/{id}/attachment

PATCH /discussion/thread/{id}/resolve

PATCH /discussion/thread/{id}/reopen

PATCH /discussion/thread/{id}/close

GET /discussion/search

GET /discussion/my-mentions

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## 23. Notification Workflow

## **MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

1. User creates message.
  2. System parses message for @mentions.
  3. System creates DiscussionMention records.
  4. System creates in-app notifications.
  5. System sends email notification to mentioned users.
  6. Mentioned user opens discussion from email or dashboard.
  7. Mentioned user replies.
  8. Original commenter receives reply notification.
  9. If resolved, system updates thread/message status.
  10. Activity log records the event.
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### **24. Resolution Workflow**

1. Auditor asks a question in a discussion.
  2. Auditor mentions a user.
  3. Mentioned user receives email and in-app notification.
  4. Mentioned user replies.
  5. Auditor or QC marks the question Answered or Resolved.
  6. If all open questions are resolved, thread status may become Resolved.
  7. Project Manager/Admin may close the thread.
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### **25. UI/UX Instructions**

Use:

Right-side discussion drawer

Discussion badge/count on supported objects

@mention user search

Message type dropdown

Status badges

Attachment control

Mark Resolved button

## **MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement**

Activity logging

Search/filter panel

Avoid:

Slack-like channels

Separate chat rooms

Unstructured general chat

Discussions detached from records

Real-time chat complexity in phase one

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### **26. Suggested Phasing**

#### **Phase 1: Core Enhanced Notes**

Object-level discussion thread

Messages

Replies

Discussion count

Right-side drawer

Activity logging

#### **Phase 2: Mentions and Notifications**

@mentions

In-app notifications

Email notifications

My Mentions dashboard

#### **Phase 3: Workflow Controls**

Question status

Resolve / reopen / close

Review requests

Search and filters

#### **Phase 4: AI Assistance**

Summarize discussion



## MyLeaseAudit Notes & Discussions Enhancement

Extract decision

Suggest checklist evidence

Suggest finding update

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### 27. Final Recommendation

Implement **Enhanced Notes & Discussions** as a contextual collaboration layer.

It should:

Enhance existing Notes

Attach discussions to audit objects

Support threaded messages

Support @mentions

Notify users by email and in-app notification

Support attachments

Support open/resolved workflow

Log activity

Remain searchable

This is the simplest effective solution because it avoids building a separate Slack-style system while giving auditors, QC reviewers, project managers, and administrators the collaboration features needed to resolve audit questions and document decisions directly inside MyLeaseAudit.

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